

FocusFlow

Personal Focus & Project Continuity App — Product Brief + Replit Build Prompt

1. Product Vision

FocusFlow is a personal web app designed to help the user stay with one meaningful task, finish software projects, recover quickly after distraction, and avoid abandoning work when a task becomes difficult, uncertain, boring, or pressured. The core loop is: choose one task → focus → capture distractions/ideas → record progress → define the next smallest action → return later.

2. Product Personality

Jarvis-inspired: futuristic, intelligent-looking, calm, supportive, playful, practical, and premium. It should encourage progress without shame, broken-streak pressure, or generic “productivity guilt.” Dark mode should be the default.

3. Core Features

Feature	Purpose
Focus Timer	Start, pause, resume and finish focused work sessions; track active and paused time.
Next Smallest Action	Every task has one concrete physical next action that makes restarting easy.
Idea Vault	Instantly save new ideas, research urges and thoughts without leaving the current task.
Projects & Tasks	Organize projects into small tasks with clear statuses and next actions.
Progress Journal	Timestamped notes for completed work, decisions, blockers and things to check next.
Feelings / Mood	Record how the user feels before and after each session.
Distraction / Switching	Record why the user wants to switch: bored, confused, pressured, blocked, new idea, distracted, tired, etc.
Insights	Show focus patterns, switching patterns, project momentum, feelings and useful trends over time.

4. Key UX Flows

Start Work: Dashboard → choose project/task → see next smallest action → write session intention → choose starting feeling → start timer.

During Focus: Minimal focus screen → timer + task + intention + progress notes + one-click Idea Vault capture.

Switch Urge: Ask why → optionally save the distraction/idea → offer a 5-minute rescue → return to current task or pause.

Finish: Record what was completed → ending feeling → next smallest action → save session.

Return: Show “Where you left off” with last progress, blocker/decision, and the exact next action.

5. Important Product Ideas

- **5-Minute Rescue:** when the user wants to abandon a task, offer a short rescue session.
- **Where Was I?:** instantly reconstruct the last working context.
- **Idea Cooldown:** new ideas can be saved for later review instead of becoming immediate projects.
- **Project Graveyard:** show paused/abandoned projects with their last action and reason for stopping.
- **Blockers:** optionally classify blockers such as “don’t know how,” “bug,” “need information,” or “need a decision.”
- **Daily Mission:** choose one meaningful outcome for the day.
- **Session Timeline:** show a chronological history of meaningful work during a session.
- **Deep Focus Mode:** optionally keep only one active project and route new ideas into the Idea Vault.

6. Main Screens

Dashboard: today's mission, active task, next action, start/resume button, today's focus time, recent activity, active projects.

Projects: project list, status, momentum, tracked time, tasks.

Task Detail: next action, status, sessions, notes, blockers, related ideas.

Focus Screen: intentionally minimal; task, intention, mood, timer, notes, quick idea capture.

Idea Vault: inbox, filters, search, review, archive/discard, convert to task/project.

Insights: focus time, switching reasons, mood patterns, project momentum and session history.

7. Design Direction

Dark futuristic interface inspired by a personal AI/Jarvis control system, but **without AI features**. Use deep charcoal/black surfaces, subtle electric accents, glowing borders, soft gradients, rounded cards, clean typography, Lucide-style icons, restrained Framer Motion animations, and a responsive layout. Use an animated orb/companion as a visual state indicator for focus, pause and completion. Avoid excessive gamification, streak pressure, cluttered dashboards, or distracting animations.

8. Scope Rules

Include now: authentication, projects/tasks, next actions, focus sessions, progress notes, Idea Vault, feelings, switching/distraction tracking, session history and initial insights.

Exclude for now: all AI/chat/voice features, AI summaries, calendar/Google Docs integrations, mobile app, team/social features, complex streak systems, heavy gamification, advanced calendar/Kanban/Gantt views.

9. Replit Build Prompt

Copy the following section into Replit as the primary build instruction. Do not expose database credentials in source code.

Build a polished responsive web app called "FocusFlow".

GOAL

Build a personal focus and project-continuity system. The app must help a user stay on one task, capture distractions and ideas without switching context, record real progress, and return later with an exact next action.

IMPORTANT

- Do NOT implement any AI, chatbot, voice assistant, AI summary, or LLM feature.
- Authentication must be email + password only.
- Build for a single primary user experience, but structure data so multiple users can safely have isolated data.
- Prioritize a working, polished MVP over unnecessary features.
- Never hard-code database credentials or secrets. Use environment variables.

CORE FEATURES

1. Email/password registration, login, logout and protected app routes.
2. Projects and tasks.
3. Every task has a "next smallest physical action".
4. Focus timer: start, pause, resume, finish.
5. Track session start/end, active duration and paused duration.
6. Session intention.
7. Starting and ending feelings.
8. Progress notes during sessions.
9. Quick Idea Vault capture without leaving the focus screen.
10. Distraction/switch tracking with reasons such as bored, confused, pressured, blocked, new idea, distracted, tired, other.
11. Finish-session reflection: completed work + next action.
12. Session history and total tracked time.
13. Dashboard with current task and easy resume flow.
14. Insights for focus time, switching reasons, feelings, project momentum and recent work.
15. Optional 5-minute rescue flow when a user wants to abandon a session.

16. "Where Was I?" resume context showing the last completed work, blocker/decision, and next action.

UX PRINCIPLES

- One important task should dominate the focus screen.
- Capturing an idea should take less than 30 seconds.
- Returning to a task should require almost no mental reconstruction.
- Do not shame the user for missed days or abandoned sessions.
- Avoid productivity scores that imply personal worth.
- Make the app feel calm, futuristic and highly intentional.

DESIGN

Create a premium dark Jarvis-inspired interface:

- deep charcoal/black background
- subtle electric accent colors
- glowing cards/borders
- rounded surfaces
- clean modern typography
- restrained animations
- animated orb/companion for focus states
- large, clear focus timer
- excellent desktop experience and responsive mobile layout
- avoid visual clutter

MAIN PAGES

- Login / Register
- Dashboard
- Projects
- Project detail
- Task detail
- Focus session
- Idea Vault
- Insights
- Settings

DATA MODEL

Create the necessary database models for:

- users
- projects
- tasks
- focus_sessions
- progress_notes
- ideas
- distraction_events / switch_events

Each user's data must be isolated from every other user.

IDEA VAULT

Allow title + optional note, type, status, created date, review date, and optional project/task/session relationship.

Types: project, feature, learning, research, thought, other.

Statuses: inbox, selected, planned, built, archived, discarded.

Allow conversion of an idea into a task or project.

TASK STATUSES

todo, active, paused, completed.

SESSION STATUSES

active, paused, completed, abandoned.

FEELINGS

Start with: excited, anxious, pressured, confused, bored, tired, calm, focused, other.

DASHBOARD

Show:

- today's mission
- current/last active task
- next smallest action
- start/resume focus button
- today's focus time
- recent sessions
- recent ideas
- active projects
- useful resume context

INSIGHTS

Start simple and useful. Show:

- total focus time
- sessions completed
- average session duration
- switching/distraction reasons
- focus time by day
- feelings before/after sessions
- project momentum
- most frequently paused/abandoned projects

Do not create a complicated productivity score.

QUALITY BAR

- polished empty states
- loading states
- error states
- form validation
- accessible buttons/forms
- keyboard-friendly interactions
- responsive design
- clear confirmation for destructive actions
- reliable timer behavior
- persistence across refreshes
- clean component structure
- no placeholder screens for core functionality

DATABASE

I will provide my database connection information separately through Replit Secrets / environment variables. Use the provided connection string securely and never place it directly in the repository, frontend code, logs, or documentation.

BUILD ORDER

1. Project setup and authentication
2. Database models and user isolation
3. Projects/tasks + next action
4. Focus timer/session persistence
5. Progress journal + feelings
6. Idea Vault
7. Distraction/switch tracking
8. Dashboard/resume experience
9. Insights
10. Final UI polish and responsive testing

After implementing, verify the complete flow:

register → create project → create task → set next action → start focus → add note → capture idea → record distraction if needed → finish session → record result + next action → return to dashboard → resume task.

10. Database Connection Note

If you want Replit to connect to your existing database, give Replit the connection string through its **Secrets / Environment Variables** system. Do not paste the actual username, password, API key, or full connection URI into this PDF, public prompt, Git repository, or frontend code. A typical variable name can be **DATABASE_URL** or another name required by the chosen database setup.

11. Definition of a Successful MVP

A user can log in, create a project and task, define the next smallest action, complete a real focus session, capture ideas without leaving the task, record feelings and distractions, finish with a progress summary and next action, then return later and immediately understand where to continue. The experience should feel like a personal focus control center—not a generic to-do list.